

Recruit Holdings (6098.T)

1Q Strong profit beat driven by growth in unit price and client numbers; AI ushering in new phase of hiring productivity globally, raise GSe and TP, maintain Buy

6098.T 12m Price Target: **¥14,900** Price: **¥13,165** Upside: **13.2%**

1Q EBITDA+S of ¥292.9 bn substantially beat our estimate of ¥238 bn and the Bloomberg consensus EBITDA of ¥222.6 bn. The beat was primarily driven by the HR Technology segment, where segment EBITDA+S of ¥215.8 bn topped our estimate of ¥167.3 bn by ¥48.5 bn. US ARPJ was up +35% yoy, well above our estimate of +24% yoy and pushing profits above forecasts. In addition, full-FY3/27 EBITDA+S guidance was revised up from ¥949 bn (+19% yoy) to ¥1,105 bn (+39% yoy), topping our previous estimate of ¥1,001 bn and the Bloomberg consensus of ¥931.8 bn by a wide margin. Full-year US ARPJ guidance was raised from +18% yoy to +30% yoy, and full-year EBITDA+S guidance for the HR Technology segment was revised from ¥677.4 bn to ¥834 bn, far ahead of our previous estimate of ¥725.9 bn.

We view this as an impressive earnings beat confirming that monetization driven by Premium Sponsored Jobs and other AI hiring products is progressing faster than we had expected. The company achieved strong growth driven by both higher unit prices and an increase in the number of customers. We think management shows deepening confidence in expanding revenue opportunities by leveraging AI to simplify hiring, and the company believes we are entering a new phase of using AI to automate the time-consuming manual tasks of HR departments and raise hiring productivity globally. We revise our FY3/27-FY3/31 EBITDA+S estimates up by a range of +15% to +30%, primarily due to an upward revision to our EBITDA+S estimates for the HR Technology segment. We raise our 12-month target price to ¥14,900 from ¥13,000. The automation of hiring processes via AI as confirmed in the 1Q results can also be viewed as steady expansion of Indeed's TAM into the hiring automation domain; we reiterate our view that Indeed still has significant room to expand monetization and that US ARPJ will continue to rise over the long term. We maintain our Buy rating as our top pick in our coverage of Japan's internet sector.

BUY

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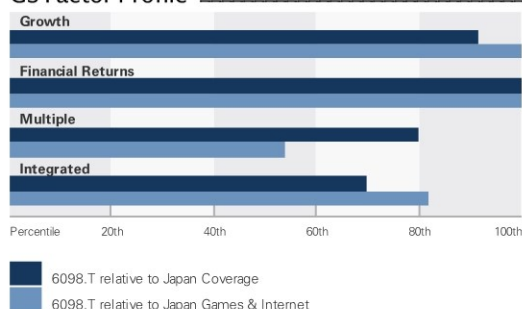
Key Data

Market cap: ¥19.3tr / \$122.0bn
Enterprise value: ¥18.4tr / \$116.5bn
3m ADTV: ¥56.9bn / \$354.8mn
Japan
Japan Games & Internet
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	3,697.4	4,286.0	4,803.8	5,286.8
Op. profit (¥ bn) New	630.6	989.1	1,336.7	1,655.6
Op. profit (¥ bn) Old	630.6	839.0	1,031.4	1,244.7
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	590.6	945.0	-	-
EPS (¥) New	349.8	568.4	814.9	1,098.0
EPS (¥) Old	349.8	483.4	630.9	828.0
P/E (X)	22.9	23.2	16.2	12.0
P/B (X)	7.1	9.8	8.0	6.2
CROCI (%)	175.2	198.6	234.8	255.6
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	145.5	137.0	137.7	148.1

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

Recruit Holdings (6098.T)

Rating since Jul 27, 2025

Ratios & Valuation

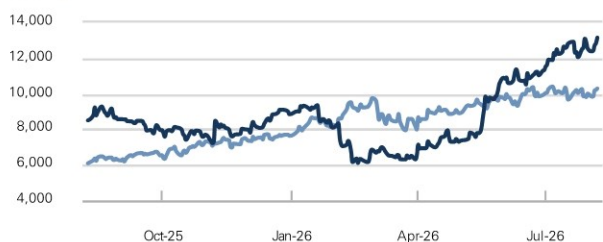
	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
P/E (X)	22.9	23.2	16.2	12.0
P/B (X)	7.1	9.8	8.0	6.2
FCF yield (%)	5.3	4.2	5.8	8.0
EV/EBITDAR (X)	15.1	15.5	10.9	8.0
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	15.1	15.5	10.9	8.0
CROCI (%)	175.2	198.6	234.8	255.6
ROE (%)	31.0	46.1	54.8	58.3
Net debt/equity (%)	(45.5)	(50.0)	(53.5)	(58.1)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	(45.5)	(50.0)	(53.5)	(58.1)
Interest cover (X)	59.9	92.3	122.4	148.9
Days inventory outst, sales	—	—	—	—
Receivable days	59.4	58.8	59.7	60.2
Duys payable outstanding	97.1	98.8	103.4	103.2
DuPont ROE (%)	31.2	43.4	51.0	53.8
Turnover (X)	1.3	1.4	1.5	1.5
Leverage (X)	1.7	1.7	1.6	1.5
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (¥)	416.6	456.8	508.8	569.7
Average capital employed (¥)	844.7	880.5	919.9	976.0
BVPS (¥)	1,134.0	1,336.9	1,650.2	2,138.2

Growth & Margins (%)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue growth	3.9	15.9	12.1	10.1
EBITDA growth	25.4	56.3	31.5	21.9
EPS growth	28.9	62.5	43.4	34.7
DPS growth	4.2	4.0	7.7	7.1
EBIT margin	17.1	23.1	27.8	31.3
EBITDA margin	19.1	25.7	30.2	33.4
Net income margin	13.4	18.0	21.7	24.3

Price Performance

6098.T (¥)



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	76.1%	86.4%	59.0%
Rel. to the TOPIX	66.0%	69.2%	16.6%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 7 Aug 2026 close.

Income Statement (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue	3,697.4	4,286.0	4,803.8	5,286.8
Cost of goods sold	(1,509.2)	(1,641.1)	(1,625.9)	(1,617.2)
SG&A	(1,527.7)	(1,655.8)	(1,841.2)	(2,014.0)
R&D	—	—	—	—
Other operating inc./exp.)	(30.0)	—	—	—
EBITDA	734.8	1,101.9	1,448.5	1,766.4
Depreciation & amortization	(74.3)	(112.8)	(111.8)	(110.8)
EBIT	630.6	989.1	1,336.7	1,655.6
Net interest inc./exp.)	24.2	24.3	24.4	24.5
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	644.6	1,004.1	1,351.7	1,670.6
Provision for taxes	(147.9)	(230.9)	(310.9)	(384.2)
Minority interest	0.2	0.3	0.3	0.3
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	496.9	773.5	1,041.1	1,286.7
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	496.9	773.5	1,041.1	1,286.7
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (¥)	349.8	568.4	814.9	1,098.0
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (¥)	347.6	564.6	809.2	1,089.7
EPS (basic, post-exception) (¥)	349.9	568.4	814.9	1,098.0
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (¥)	347.8	564.6	809.2	1,089.7
DPS (¥)	25.0	26.0	28.0	30.0
Div. payout ratio (%)	7.1	4.6	3.4	2.7

Balance Sheet (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Cash & cash equivalents	725.6	892.5	1,091.9	1,389.7
Accounts receivable	639.3	741.0	830.6	914.1
Inventory	—	—	—	—
Other current assets	190.3	190.3	190.3	190.3
Total current assets	1,555.2	1,823.9	2,112.8	2,494.1
Net PP&E	57.2	36.9	22.5	13.9
Net intangibles	163.3	140.7	118.4	96.2
Total investments	135.3	135.3	135.3	135.3
Other long-term assets	878.1	878.1	878.1	878.1
Total assets	2,789.0	3,015.0	3,267.0	3,617.6
Accounts payable	425.5	462.7	458.5	456.0
Short-term debt	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Short-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other current liabilities	449.8	449.8	449.8	449.8
Total current liabilities	875.3	912.5	908.2	905.8
Long-term debt	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Long-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other long-term liabilities	318.5	318.5	318.5	318.5
Total long-term liabilities	319.1	319.1	319.1	319.1
Total liabilities	1,194.5	1,231.7	1,227.4	1,224.9
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	1,583.3	1,772.4	2,029.0	2,382.3
Minority interest	11.2	10.9	10.6	10.3
Total liabilities & equity	2,789.0	3,015.0	3,267.0	3,617.6
Net debt, adjusted	(724.9)	(891.9)	(1,091.3)	(1,389.1)

Cash Flow (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Net income	496.9	773.5	1,041.1	1,286.7
D&A add-back	74.3	112.8	111.8	110.8
Minority interest add-back	(0.2)	(0.3)	(0.3)	(0.3)
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(26.2)	(64.6)	(93.8)	(86.0)
Other operating cash flow	124.6	—	—	—
Cash flow from operations	669.4	821.4	1,058.8	1,311.2
Capital expenditures	(62.3)	(70.0)	(75.0)	(80.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	12.5	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(49.7)	(70.0)	(75.0)	(80.0)
Repayment of lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(36.5)	(34.5)	(34.4)	(33.4)
Inc/(dec) in debt	(0.4)	—	—	—
Other financing cash flows	(665.9)	(550.0)	(750.0)	(900.0)
Cash flow from financing	(702.7)	(584.5)	(784.4)	(933.4)
Total cash flow	(42.3)	167.0	199.4	297.8
Free cash flow	607.1	751.4	983.8	1,231.2

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

Key points from 1Q results / our earnings estimates

1Q results: 1Q sales/EBITDA+S in the HR Technology segment were ¥455.4 bn/¥215.8 bn, substantially beating our estimates of ¥426.5 bn/¥167.3 bn. While the number of US job postings in 1Q continued to decline as expected at -4% yoy, the US ARPJ growth rate was +35% yoy, well above our estimate of +24% yoy. In addition to the US, which was driven by upside in ARPJ, sales in Europe and other regions also landed strongly at +28% yoy, compared to our estimate of +20%. Furthermore, the 1Q EBITDA+S margin for the HR Technology segment improved to 47.4% (+12.4 ppt yoy), exceeding our estimate of 39.2%. A major decrease in the broadly defined personnel cost ratio (which includes outsourcing expenses), from 48% in 1Q3/26 to 37% in 1Q3/27, contributed to the margin beat. Recruit commented that although token costs are on an upward trend with the expanding use of AI, they have not yet reached a level that has a major impact on margins.

FY3/27 guidance / longer-term earnings outlook: FY3/27 EBITDA+S guidance was raised from ¥949 bn to ¥1,105 bn (+¥156 bn). Of this, EBITDA+S guidance for the HR Technology segment was lifted from ¥677.4 bn to ¥834 bn (+¥156.6 bn), while other segments were revised slightly or left unchanged. The upward revision to US ARPJ guidance (from +18% yoy to +30% yoy) was the main driver of the upward revision for the HR Technology segment. With the evolution of AI products, Indeed is transforming from a job search engine into a highly accurate, high-value-added matching platform. The company noted that the streamlining of hiring activities through Indeed's AI products is progressing faster than expected, and while this increases the difficulty of precisely forecasting short-term earnings, it expressed strong confidence in the substantial room for medium-to-long-term growth. It sees scope for AI products to widen its business domain into a broader TAM encompassing recruiting/staffing/hiring automation, and to expand the market size itself by making hiring activities as simple as possible.

Changes in hiring activities due to evolution of Indeed's AI matching: Indeed's AI products are automating cumbersome manual hiring tasks such as candidate sourcing, resume screening, and interview scheduling, thereby shortening the time to hire. Because vacancies are such a critical matter for SMEs, Recruit says SMEs are adopting these products even if it means incurring costs. For large enterprises, meanwhile, AI products have been proven to deliver results equivalent to several recruiters, leading to an increase in the number of customers utilizing Indeed's AI options. The company also asserted that increasing matching accuracy at the application stage, which can be viewed as the pre-process of hiring, reduces the volume of later processes in hiring (interviews, communication, etc.), and that this could boost competitive advantage with SaaS and other companies' AI tools. We found this an interesting point and a differentiating factor for Indeed as a high-value-added matching platform. Job seekers also realize they can get faster replies and find jobs quickly on Indeed because companies are automating their processes, which has resulted in an increase in visitor numbers as well. On the other hand, the company commented that since AI is driving up average revenue per user faster than expected, it plans to closely monitor customer satisfaction and help clients carefully manage the change to prevent a deceleration over the medium to long term.

Our estimates/valuation: We revise our FY3/27-FY3/31 EBITDA+S estimates up by a range of +15% to +30%. The increase to our EBITDA+S estimates for the HR Technology

segment (+21% to +38% vs. previous outlook) is the primary background for this upward revision. We forecast FY3/27 consolidated EBITDA+S at ¥1,150.6 bn (vs. guidance of ¥1,105 bn), and the US ARPJ growth rate at +33% yoy (vs. guidance of +30%). Note that since the changes to our US macro team's US nonfarm payroll forecasts are very minor compared to the time of our previous earnings estimate revision in May, we leave our US job posting assumptions unchanged in our earnings estimates for Recruit Holdings. Reflecting the revisions to our earnings estimates and updates to our applied multiples, we raise our 12-month target price to ¥14,900 from ¥13,000. We reiterate our view that Indeed has substantial room to expand monetization and that US ARPJ will continue to rise over the long term. We maintain our Buy rating as our top pick in the internet sector.

Exhibit 1: 1Q3/27 results vs. GSe/Bloomberg consensus; percent change in our estimates

Jun Q EBITDA+S (¥bn)			HR Technology Sales (USD mn)		HR Technology EBITDA+S (¥bn)	
Actual	GSe	BBG consensus	Actual	GSe	Actual	GSe
292.9	238.0	222.6	2,856	2,677	215.8	167.3

GSe change (% , FY3/27)			GSe change (% , FY3/28-FY3/31)		
EBITDA+S (total)	HR Technology Sales (USD)	HR Technology EBITDA+S (¥)	EBITDA+S (total)	HR Technology Sales (USD)	HR Technology EBITDA+S (¥)
+15%	+8%	+21%	+25%~+30%	+14%~+18%	+34%~+38%

Source: Bloomberg, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Recruit Holdings: Our TP model

Recruit Holdings SOTP (¥mn)	
Adj. EBITDA (FY2, 3/2028E)	1,200,400
Global Internet high-margin, high-growth median EV/EBITDA (FY2)	11.9 x
HR Technology (Indeed) EV	14,241,567
Adj. EBITDA (FY2, 3/2028E)	210,600
Japan internet sector median EV/EBITDA (FY2)	11.0 x
Marketing Matching Technologies EV	2,317,129
Adj. EBITDA (FY2, 3/2028E)	107,100
Staffing sector median EV/EBITDA (FY2)	6.4 x
Staffing EV	681,818
Recruit Holdings EV	17,240,513
Net cash (debt)	1,091,252
Minority interests	10,636
Implied market cap	18,331,766
Number of shares (mn)	1,230
12-m target price (¥)	¥ 14,900

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Recruit Holdings: Income statement

	2021 3/2022	2022 3/2023	2023 3/2024	2024 3/2025	2025 3/2026	2026E 3/2027	2026E 3/2027	2027E 3/2028	2028E 3/2029	2029E 3/2030	2030E 3/2031	1Q26 6/2026	2Q26E 9/2026	3Q26E 12/2026	4Q26E 3/2027
JPY millions															
Revenue	2,871,705	3,429,519	3,416,492	3,557,478	3,697,351	4,230,000	4,286,000	4,803,800	5,286,800	5,776,300	6,274,200	1,045,530	1,069,600	1,079,300	1,091,570
YoY	27%	19%	0%	4%	4%	14%	16%	12%	10%	9%	9%	19%	17%	14%	14%
HR Technology	861,400	1,116,159	1,011,820	1,126,565	1,458,419	1,822,000	1,877,300	2,265,700	2,625,200	2,998,700	3,375,800	455,444	471,900	459,500	490,456
YoY	103.5%	29.6%	-9.3%	11.3%	29.5%	24.9%	28.7%	20.7%	15.9%	14.2%	12.6%	33.3%	32.7%	27.6%	22.4%
USD basis (\$mn)	7,652	8,243	7,003	7,378	9,674	11,485	11,745	14,161	16,407	18,742	21,098	2,856	2,950	2,872	3,067
YoY	81.7%	7.7%	-17%	5.1%	21%	18.7%	21.4%	20.6%	14.9%	14.2%	12.6%	29.9%	22.2%	22.7%	19.9%
US (\$mn)	5,722	6,002	4,841	4,883	5,314	6,650	6,824	8,489	10,007	11,570	13,160	1,641	1,720	1,667	1,796
YoY	88.5%	4.9%	-19.3%	0.9%	8.8%	25.1%	28.4%	24.4%	17.9%	15.6%	13.7%	29.9%	28.9%	27.9%	27.0%
Non-US (\$mn)	1,930	2,241	2,162	2,495	4,359	4,835	4,921	5,671	6,400	7,172	7,938	1,215	1,230	1,205	1,271
YoY	101.7%	16.1%	-3.6%	15.4%	74.7%	10.9%	12.6%	15.3%	12.8%	12.1%	10.7%	18.1%	14.0%	16.1%	11.3%
Marketing Matching Technology (ex Matching & Solutions)	658,616	760,687	807,842	816,013	564,662	605,000	605,200	643,200	680,100	715,900	753,000	141,894	154,400	153,600	155,306
YoY	2.0%	15.6%	6.2%	1.0%	-30.8%	7.1%	7.2%	6.3%	5.7%	5.3%	5.2%	3.7%	6.9%	7.0%	11.1%
Staffing	1,378,492	1,585,274	1,634,239	1,666,994	1,703,436	1,831,000	1,831,500	1,924,900	2,013,500	2,095,700	2,181,400	455,224	450,800	473,700	451,776
YoY	19.0%	15.0%	3.1%	2.0%	2.1%	7.2%	7.5%	5.1%	4.6%	4.1%	4.1%	11.5%	12.0%	6.1%	5.7%
Domestic staffing	604,900	684,100	751,600	805,100	846,800	873,000	872,200	898,400	925,400	953,200	981,800	220,200	215,700	220,300	216,000
YoY	6.1%	13.1%	9.9%	7.1%	5.2%	3.1%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.5%	3.0%	3.0%	2.5%
Overseas staffing	773,500	901,100	882,600	861,800	856,500	958,000	959,300	1,026,500	1,088,100	1,142,500	1,199,600	235,000	235,100	253,400	235,800
YoY	20.0%	16.0%	-2.1%	-2.4%	-0.4%	11.9%	12.0%	7.0%	6.0%	5.6%	5.0%	25.3%	11.0%	8.0%	4.7%
Adjustments	(26,804)	(32,601)	(37,409)	(52,095)	(29,166)	(28,000)	(28,000)	(30,000)	(32,000)	(34,000)	(36,000)	(7,032)	(7,500)	(7,500)	(5,968)
EBITDA* (Adjusted EBITDA)	511,816	545,043	598,397	678,889	794,390	1,105,000	1,150,600	1,504,100	1,829,500	2,163,300	2,496,500	292,891	292,800	292,800	272,109
YoY change	107%	6%	10%	13%	17%	39%	45%	31%	22%	18%	15%	56%	41%	34%	50%
EBITDA Margin (%)	18%	16%	18%	19%	21%	26%	27%	31%	35%	37%	40%	28%	27%	27%	25%
HR Technology	323,345	342,309	344,390	404,113	549,995	834,000	878,600	1,200,400	1,496,300	1,803,500	2,112,100	215,771	219,200	218,100	223,529
EBITDA Margin (%)	37.5%	30.7%	34.0%	35.9%	37.7%	45.8%	46.7%	53.0%	57.0%	60.1%	62.6%	47.4%	46.5%	47.5%	45.6%
Marketing Matching Technology (ex Matching & Solution)	102,810	109,809	163,665	185,957	154,976	181,500	183,100	210,600	236,300	259,500	280,400	51,137	47,200	46,900	37,863
EBITDA Margin (%)	15.6%	14.4%	20.3%	22.8%	27.4%	30.0%	30.3%	32.7%	34.7%	36.2%	37.2%	36.0%	30.6%	30.5%	24.4%
Staffing	93,295	102,258	97,947	97,422	99,744	102,500	103,900	107,100	111,900	116,300	121,000	28,290	28,900	30,300	16,410
EBITDA Margin (%)	6.8%	6.5%	6.0%	5.8%	5.9%	5.6%	5.7%	5.6%	5.6%	5.5%	5.5%	6.2%	6.4%	6.4%	3.6%
Adjustments	(5,835)	(7,534)	(6,706)	(7,532)	(10,326)	(13,000)	(13,000)	(14,000)	(15,000)	(16,000)	(17,000)	(2,308)	(2,500)	(2,500)	(5,692)
Operating profit	378,929	344,303	402,526	490,542	630,567	945,000	989,100	1,336,700	1,655,600	1,982,200	2,307,400	255,413	256,200	255,200	222,287
YoY (%)	133%	-9%	17%	22%	20%	50%	57%	35%	24%	20%	16%	69%	60%	49%	85%
Operating profit margin	13.2%	10.0%	11.8%	13.8%	17.1%	22.3%	23.1%	27.8%	31.3%	34.3%	36.8%	24.4%	24.0%	23.6%	20.4%
Non-operating income/expenses	23,462	23,462	23,715	36,602	14,052		15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	15,000	8,122	5,000	5,000	(3,122)
Pretax profit	382,749	367,767	426,241	527,143	644,619		1,004,100	1,351,700	1,670,600	1,997,200	2,322,400	263,535	261,200	260,200	219,165
Corporate tax	(85,026)	(96,096)	(71,645)	(118,983)	(147,808)		(230,800)	(310,900)	(384,200)	(469,400)	(534,200)	(81,006)	(85,300)	(85,100)	(99,492)
Corporate tax rate	22.2%	26.1%	16.8%	22.6%	22.9%		23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	23.1%	25.0%	25.0%	18.0%
Minority interest	(889)	(1,872)	(942)	0	231		300	300	300	300	300	91	-	-	209
Net income	296,833	269,799	353,654	408,594	496,812	755,000	773,500	1,041,100	1,286,700	1,538,100	1,788,500	202,618	195,900	195,100	179,882
EPS	161.7	168.6	225.4	271.4	349.9	543.9	568.4	814.9	1,098.9	1,409.3	1,988.5	145.5	137.9	137.7	148.1

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis - Recruit Holdings

Recruit Holdings is an internet company with three core segments: HR technology (matching job seekers and companies via Indeed and Glassdoor), marketing matching technology (providing matching platform services to connect individual users and companies in the fields of housing, beauty, travel, and dining, etc.), and SaaS products centered on Air Business Tools in Japan), and staffing (providing staffing services in Japan, Europe, the US, and Australia).

We are Buy rated on Recruit. At Indeed, hiring speed has accelerated due to higher-quality candidate recommendations from AI, creating a virtuous cycle that is also leading to higher job seeker satisfaction, and the results of efforts to refine AI matching using proprietary data from both companies and job seekers are starting to be confirmed in earnings. In addition, we believe Indeed has vast room for future growth in monetization compared to competing platforms, and that US ARPJ will continue to trend higher over the long term.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Recruit Holdings

Our 12-month target price of ¥14,900 is based on SOTP, using FY3/28E as a base year. We assume target EV/EBITDA multiples of 11.9x/11.0x/6.4x for the HR Technology/Marketing Matching Technology/Global Staffing segments. Key downside risks to our target price are as follows. (1) Macro environment: Risks include possible changes in job market momentum due to a sharp deterioration in macro conditions, mainly in the US, and a resulting weaker-than-expected earnings performance in the HR technology business. (2) Indeed monetization: Indeed has introduced numerous measures to increase monetization. Risks include progress with monetization at the platform falling short of our assumptions. (3) Capital allocation: Equity investors appear to largely expect Recruit to continue with share buybacks of a certain size. Risks include shareholder returns falling short of market expectations.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Minami Munakata and Haruki Kubota, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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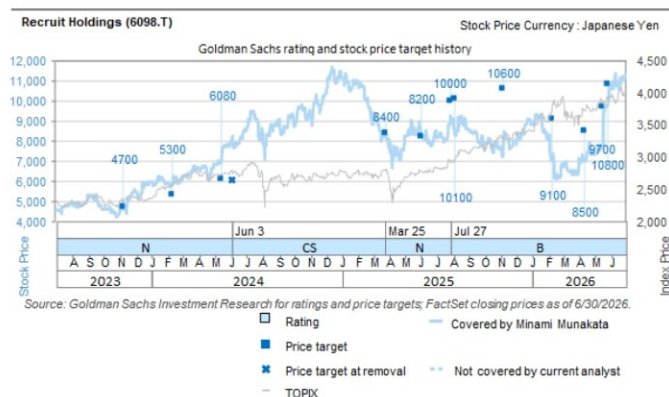
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Target price history table(s)

Recruit Holdings (6098.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Aug-26	14,900	13,165
06-Jul-26	13,000	11,895
26-May-26	10,800	9,824
15-May-26	9,700	7,825
12-Apr-26	8,500	7,117
09-Feb-26	9,100	7,153
06-Nov-25	10,600	7,311
05-Aug-25	10,100	8,719
27-Jul-25	10,000	8,822
03-Jun-25	8,200	8,200
25-Mar-25	8,400	8,305
15-May-24	6,080	7,066
10-Feb-24	5,300	5,887
08-Nov-23	4,700	4,980

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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